

68.2 "NEITHER OF," "EITHER OF," AND "BOTH OF"

"Either of," "neither of," and "both of" are used before a plural pronoun or a determiner plus a plural noun.

"Bicycles" is a plural noun.
I could buy **either of** these bicycles,
but I don't really need **either of** them.



"Them" is a plural pronoun.

We won **neither of** the races.
Neither of us trained hard enough.



"Of" is optional after
"both" when a determiner is
used with the noun.

We train with **both (of)** our coaches.
They are proud of **both of** us.



Plural personal pronouns "us," "you," and "them" can be used with "either of," "neither of," and "both of" as a subject as well as an object.

I danced with **both of** them.



"Them" is the object.

Neither of you can dance.



"You" is the subject.

FURTHER EXAMPLES

I wasn't able to get tickets
for **either of** the first heats.



Neither of the athletes
are very fit.



I'm going to watch **both** the
equestrian events later today.



Either of them could win the
contest. It's hard to call.



We thought **neither of** them
would be able to finish.



Both of you are strong
contenders. You deserve to win.

